

1.1.1 Comprehensive

Android is a comprehensive platform, i.e. it has the complete software stack to run on a portable device. The SDK consists of all required tools and framework for developers to write and deploy efficient applications for a device.

1.1.2 Made for Mobile Phones

Android was built with the idea of being incorporated in predominantly battery-powered smaller-sized devices restricted in memory and processing speed; thus delivering to a platform with a unique and better user experience. It doesn't assume a device's screen size, resolution, chipset, etc., and its core is designed for portability.

1.2 Incentive for Google

You may wonder how Google makes money if Android is released under a free and open-source license. The ideology that Google adopted while acquiring Android Inc in 2005 was to proliferate Android devices in the market, and not stop at launching just the gPhone. It wanted to develop a platform that would lure multiple manufacturers to imbibe this in their handsets. Predominantly being a media and advertising company, Google aspires to provide additional services to its advertisers through handheld devices.

Did you know? The first version of Android SDK was released without an actual device in the market. You don't need a phone for Android development; the SDK provides you with all the bits you need for developing on this platform.

Android, as such, is owned by the Open Handset Alliance – a non-profit formed by major mobile operators, device manufacturers and carriers and led by Google. It is committed to openness and innovation for mobile user experience.

1.3 Versions

Android has released several versions as listed below:

Version numbers change every time there is a considerable amount of bug fixes for an issue or when the API is revised.

Android Version	API Level	Codename
Android 1.0	1	
Android 1.1	2	
Android 1.5	3	Cupcake
Android 1.6	4	Donut
Android 2.0	5	Eclair
Android 2.01	6	Eclair
Android 2.1	7	Eclair
Android 2.2	8	Froyo
Android 2.3	9	Gingerbread
Android 2.3.3	10	Gingerbread
Android 3	11	Honeycomb